

Romain Sickenberg

Backend-Software Engineer

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Backend Software Engineer with **5+ years** building and maintaining business-critical web applications and **REST APIs** with **PHP**, **Symfony**, **Laravel**, **React** and **Docker**.

Hands-on across application design, component integration and deployment (**CI/CD**), including code review, production releases and technical leadership of medium-sized projects.

Work authorization: Swiss Citizen. Available now.

Experience

Full-Stack Software Developer

03.2024 - 12.2025

Academic Work SA

IT Consulting for diverse clients via Academic Work.

- Designed a decoupled backend/frontend architecture for SIL Lausanne and built the **Docker** base platform underpinning most of their in-house solutions (**Python**, **Django**, **Vue**, **React**).
 - Shipped a **React (Next.js)** application with **GitHub Actions CI/CD**, **Docker** containerization and automated deployments to Jelastic.
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Backend Software Engineer

10.2021 - 02.2023

Antistatique SA

From Junior to mid-level Software Engineer & highest skill jump!

- Built and maintained enterprise **Symfony 6** applications and their **REST APIs (API Platform)**, on **PHP 7.4/8.0** with **Doctrine ORM**, **PostgreSQL**, **Redis** caching and **Elasticsearch** indexing.
 - Led a five-developer team as **PHP Lead Developer** on a 3-4 month **Symfony** build for Colis du Coeur, shipping v1 of a state-machine-driven workflow for volunteer distribution centres.
 - Delivered and maintained six CMS builds - five **Drupal**, one **WordPress**.
 - Cut **GitHub Actions** execution time by **75%** through dependency caching and workflow optimization.
 - Owned technical delivery and led code reviews on small to medium-sized projects, including a client platform hosted on **AWS**, to enforce maintainability and development standards.
 - Built a small internal tool on a **serverless Firebase** backend with a **Vue.js** front end.
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Junior Backend Software Engineer

02.2021 - 10.2021

Ilem Group

IT Consulting to an external client named Berdoz Vision & Audition.

- Secured and migrated a business-critical ERP serving **20 retail stores** to a newer **PHP** version, then co-built its **Laravel** replacement.
 - Configured a fleet of **44 iPads** and set up CI servers running **Codeception** and **Cypress** test suites.
 - Hardened security and developed critical components of the in-house CRM used across that same 20-store network.
 - Implemented internal tooling for automated testing, monitoring and deployment, with **Sentry** for error tracking.
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Apprentice Software Engineer

06.2016 - 06.2020

Liip AG

- Developed and extended internal web applications in **PHP** and **JavaScript**.
- Shipped features in an **Agile** team with **Git** and **Scrum**.
- Developed custom **Moodle** plugins with **PHP 5.4**.

Personal Breaks & Side Activities

- Security agent at Securitas AG - part-time, event sector. 07.2023 - 03.2024
- Planned career break - solo world travel and personal development. 02.2023 - 06.2023
- Swiss Armed Forces - mandatory military service. 07.2020 - 11.2020

Skills

Backend

PHP · Symfony · Laravel ·
REST APIs · Python ·
Node.js · C# · Java

Databases

PostgreSQL · MySQL ·
MariaDB · Prisma ·
Supabase · Redis ·
Elasticsearch

Cloud & DevOps

Docker · GitHub Actions ·
CI/CD · Linux · Apache ·
Nginx · AWS ·
Google Cloud Platform (GCP)
· Firebase · Serverless

Tools

Git · GitLab · Composer ·
Jira · Confluence · Scrum ·
Sentry · Bash

Frontend

TypeScript · JavaScript ·
React · Vue.js · Next.js ·
Nuxt.js · NPM · Bun ·
HTML5 · CSS · Sass ·
Tailwind CSS · Alpine.js

Mobile

Swift 5 · iOS ·
WatchOS · Combine ·
Intents · Swift UI

Education

Swiss Confederation | EPSIC @ Lausanne & CFPT @ Geneva 08.2016 - 07.2020
Federal VET Diploma in Information Technology (CFC)

Projects

Tesla Companion 01.2018 - 01.2023
Paid iOS & WatchOS App to work around Tesla cars.
• Built and published a commercial **iOS** and **watchOS** application integrating **Tesla APIs** reaching over **1,000 daily active users** and ranking **#5** in the App Store Trips category.

Fort-To-Nite 01.2017 - 01.2019
Free iOS wiki around Fortnite with live in-game shop indications and **Django** back-end.
• Fortnite companion app with **100,000+ downloads**, **4.6/5.0★ rating (340+ reviews)** and a peak ranking of **#19** in the App Store Reference category.

Awards

EPFL Hackathon AR/VR Game Experiences 12.2019 - 12.2019
RA \ VR Hackathon
Built a "digital museum" in Virtual reality. Won the **first place** in VR experiences, built with **SteamVR** and **Unity**.

Languages

French: Native (C2) · **English:** Fluent (C2) · **German:** Intermediate (B1)